



The Talent Partner Unlocking Tomorrow's Workforces

Retail Banking, KYC & Financial Crime Foundations

Open-Source Research & KYC Data Analysis

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Open-Source Research Techniques



Open-Source Research Techniques

Role of OSINT & Establishing the Research Objective



Role of OSINT in FinCrime



Accesses **publicly available information**



Supports **KYC/CDD, investigations** and ongoing monitoring



Provides **additional context** on customers, businesses and related parties



Helps identify potential **risk indicators**



Establishing the Research Objective



Define **what you need to find** and why



Identify **key entities, terms** and relevant information



Set **appropriate scope** based on the purpose and risk context



Plan and **document** your **search approach** to ensure consistency



Open-Source Research Techniques

Individual Customer & Professional Research



Individual Customer Research



Review publicly available **identity** and **profile** information



Look for relevant **associations** and **online presence**



Check reputable **news sources** and **public records**



Identify potential **risk indicators** relevant to FinCrime



Professional Customer Research



Review **business registration** and **corporate information**



Identify **ownership**, **control persons** and **key management**



Look for **industry information** and **business activities**



Check **media coverage**, **regulatory information** and other **relevant sources**



Open-Source Research Techniques

Legal Entity & Corporate Registry Research



Key Information to Review



Verify **legal name** and registered details



Review **business structure** and current status



Identify **registered address** and contact information



Review **filing history** and key dates



Additional Research Considerations



Identify **owners, control persons** and key management



Look for **related entities, affiliates** or corporate links



Check **industry classification** and **business activities**



Look for **red flags** such as inconsistent or inactive status



Open-Source Research Techniques

Business Website & Digital Presence Review



What to Review on the Business Website



Business overview, **products and services**



Management team and key personnel



Business locations and contact details



Recent announcements, news and **corporate updates**



Additional Digital Presence Checks



Review **social media** presence and activity



Look for **customer reviews** and online feedback



Identify third-party news coverage and **industry mentions**



Check for **inconsistencies** or **red flags** across different online sources



Open-Source Research Techniques

Address & Geographic Research



What to Review



Verify residential or business **address details**



Confirm **geographic location** and jurisdiction



Assess whether the address is **commercial, residential** or a **virtual office**



Look for **additional address information** and associated entities



Additional Considerations



Identify links to **high-risk locations** or jurisdictions



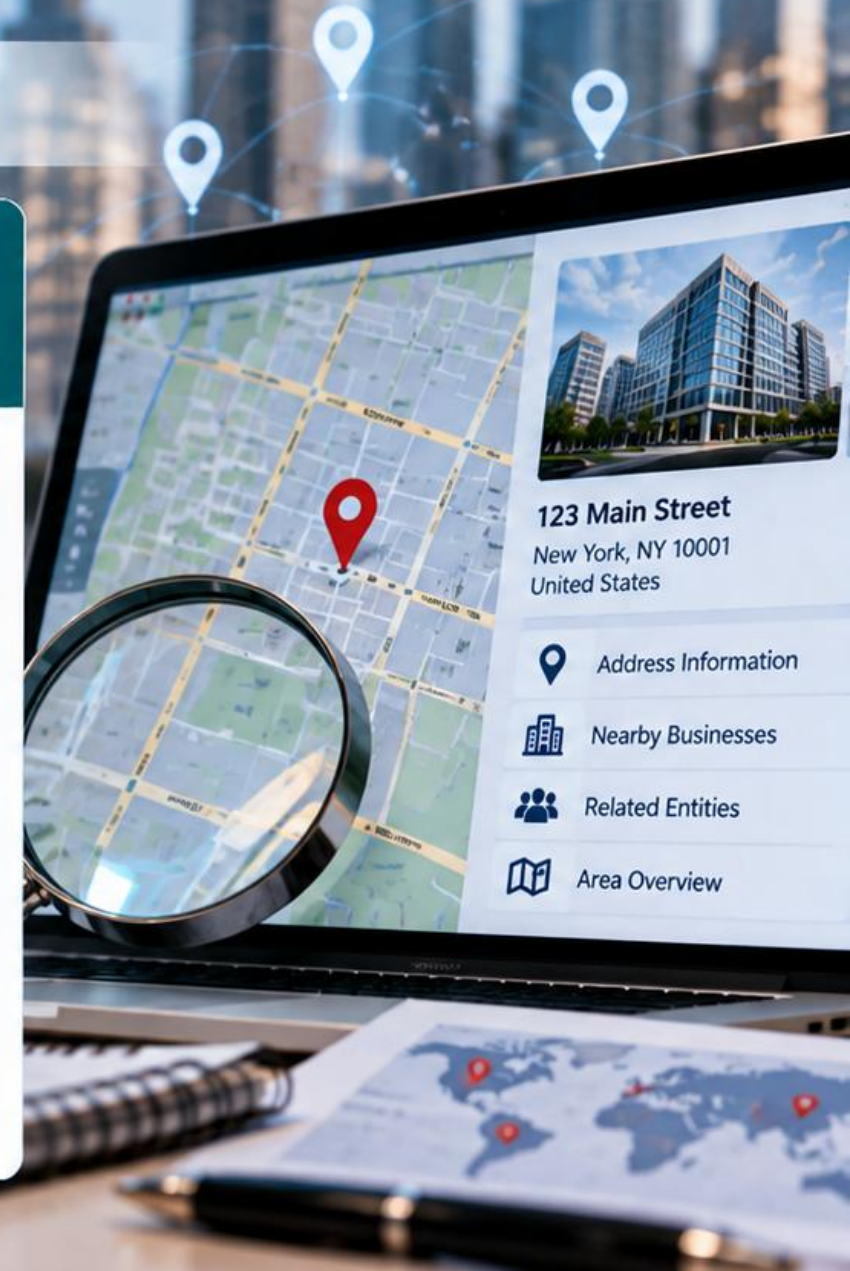
Use **satellite maps** and **street view** to understand the location



Check for **multiple businesses** or unrelated entities at the same address



Look for **inconsistencies** or **red flags** in address information



Open-Source Research Techniques

Ownership, Management & Related Entity Research



What to Research



Identify **ultimate owners** and control persons



Review **key management personnel** and their background



Look for **related entities**, affiliates, subsidiaries or common ownership



Assess **changes in ownership** or **management**



Additional Considerations



Use **multiple public sources** to corroborate information



Identify **links to other businesses** or high-risk entities



Check **adverse media** on owners, management and related entities



Look for **inconsistencies** or **red flags** across sources



Open-Source Research Techniques

Regulatory & Licensing Research



What to Review



Check regulatory **registrations** and **licenses**



Confirm **current status** and **validity**



Review **regulatory history** including disciplinary actions



Verify **scope of authorization** and permitted activities



Additional Considerations



Use **state, federal and international** regulatory sources where relevant



Check **related licenses** for owners, management and affiliated entities



Look for past **enforcement actions, fines** or **suspensions**



Identify **inconsistencies or red flags** in regulatory information

Regulatory Search

Search by company, individual or license number



Regulators



License Search



Enforcement Actions



Registrant Information

Regulator	License Type	Status
SEC	Investment Adviser	Active
FINRA	Broker-Dealer	Active
CFTC	Commodity Pool Operator	Active
NFA	Introducing Broker	Inactive
State Regulator	Money Services Business	Active

SEC Filings

FINRA BrokerCheck

State Licensing

Enforcement Records

Open-Source Research Techniques

Adverse Media Research



What to Review



News articles on the customer, owners, management and related entities



Reports on **legal, regulatory or enforcement issues**



Information on **financial crime, fraud or misconduct**



Relevant **negative coverage** in local, national and international media



Additional Considerations



Use **multiple reliable sources** including reputable news outlets and industry publications



Consider **global search coverage** and different languages where relevant



Assess **relevance, credibility and recency** of the information



Look for **consistent patterns** or recurring negative information across sources



Open-Source Research Techniques

Name Variations, Aliases & Identity Resolution



What to Look For



Alternative spellings
and transliterations



Aliases, former names
or known as (K/A) names



Name variations from
marriage, cultural or
language differences



Associated individuals
and **linked identifiers**
(e.g., address, phone, email)



Additional Considerations



Use **multiple search terms**
and common variations



Consider **different languages**,
transliterations and naming
conventions



Compare information across
multiple sources to link records



Be alert to **inconsistencies**
that may indicate related
identities or potential red flags



Open-Source Research Techniques

Source Reliability, Corroboration & OSINT Limitations



Source Reliability



Use **official and reputable sources** where possible



Be cautious with **blogs, forums** or **unverified online claims**



Assess the **credibility, objectivity** and **potential bias** of the source



Check the **date of the information** to ensure it is current and relevant



Additional Considerations



Corroborate information across **multiple independent sources**



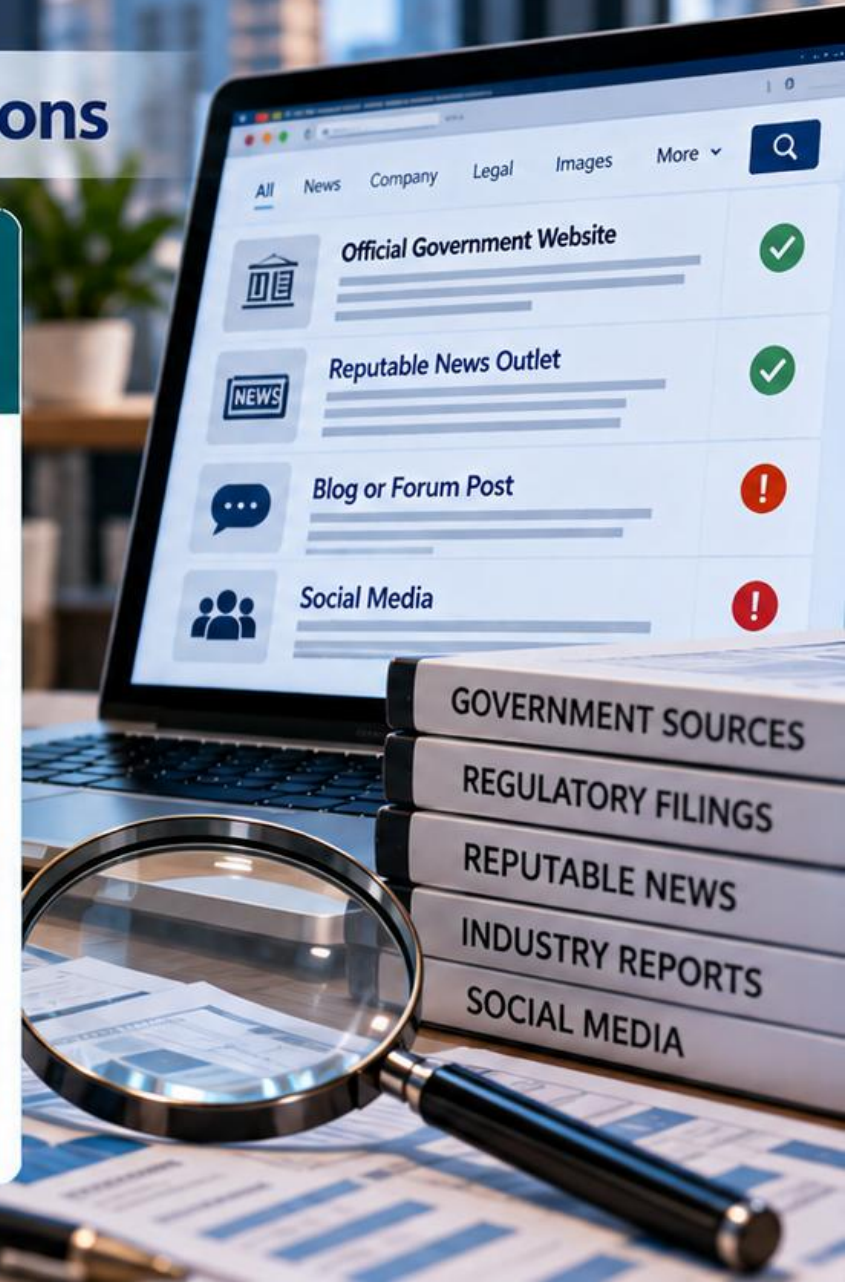
Look for **consistent information** and identify any conflicting details



Understand that **limited online presence** does not necessarily indicate risk



Be aware of **OSINT limitations** and use professional judgment based on the totality of information



Building Effective Search Strings



Building Effective Search Strings

Exact Name & Exact-Phrase Searches



1

Why Exact Searches Are Important



Help find the exact individual or entity



Reduce irrelevant results



Useful for verifying specific identity information



Support more accurate KYC/CDD and investigations

2

How to Do Exact Name Searches



Use quotation marks (" ") around the full name or phrase



Search full name (e.g., first, middle, last name)



Use exact business name for entities



Include relevant identifiers where useful (e.g., city, state)

3

When to Use Exact-Phrase Searches



Searching for a complete name or phrase



Identifying a specific individual or entity



Searching for unique business names or legal entity names



Finding specific quotes, headlines or statements

4

Things to Keep in Mind



Results may be limited if the exact phrase is not widely available



Try alternative formats if no results are found (e.g., initials, with/without middle name)



Combine with other search terms where relevant



Review multiple sources to confirm the information

5

Common Uses in FinCrime Research



Customer and beneficial owner name searches



Exact legal entity name searches



Director or key management name searches



Search for specific news articles or public statements

Exact-Phrase Search Elements



Quotation marks (" ")



Full name or entity name



Initials Where Relevant



Location Terms (e.g., city, state)



Business Identifiers (e.g., legal name)



Exact Phrases (e.g., names, quotes)



Combine with Additional Terms

Building Effective Search Strings

Name Variations, Aliases & Alternative Spellings



1 Why Consider Name Variations



Help identify the same individual or entity with different name formats



Improve completeness of KYC/CDD, EDD and investigations



Useful when names appear differently across sources and jurisdictions



Reduce the risk of missing relevant information

2 Common Types of Name Variations



Different spellings (e.g., Mohammed / Muhammad)



Use of initials (e.g., Ahmed R.)



Nicknames or common aliases



Name order changes (e.g., Khan, Ali)



Use of prefixes (e.g., Dr., Mr., Al, bin, de)



Typos or transliterations

3 Building Search Strings With Name Variations



Use multiple spellings

- Include common alternative spellings
- Consider regional variations



Include initials and partial names

- Use first name, last name
- Add middle name or initial
- Search with and without initials



Include aliases and known variations

- Add common nicknames
- Include transliterations where relevant

4 Other Useful Considerations



Consider different languages and transliterations



Include location terms when helpful



Search related entities or accounts using name variations



Combine with other identifiers (e.g., address, employer)



Use quotation marks and other search operators as needed

5 Review and Refine Search Results



Confirm results refer to the same individual or entity



Look for consistent information across multiple sources



Identify any additional name variations found in the results



Decide if further searches are needed based on risk and relevance

Examples of Name Variation Types to Consider



Different spellings



Initials and abbreviations



Nicknames or aliases



Name order changes



Prefixes and titles



Transliterations and translations



Common typos



Related individuals or entities

Building Effective Search Strings

Customer Identifier Searches



1

Why Customer Identifier Searches Matter



Help distinguish the customer from individuals or entities with similar names



Support accurate identity verification and risk assessment



Useful in KYC/CDD, EDD and investigations



Help identify potential adverse information or related entities

2

Key Customer Identifiers



Full legal name (including variations)



Date of birth



City / state or location



Identification number (e.g., SSN, passport, driver's license where relevant)



Phone number



Email address



Associated entities or accounts

3

Building Search Strings With Identifiers



Use exact name

- Full name
- Include middle name or initial if needed



Add additional identifiers

- City / state
- Employer or business name
- Date of birth (where relevant)



Include variations

- Nicknames or known aliases
- Common misspellings



Combine identifiers as needed

- Name + location
- Name + employer
- Name + ID number

4

Additional Search Considerations



Use quotation marks for exact phrases



Combine multiple identifiers



Exclude irrelevant terms



Refine using location, date or other filters



Start broad, then narrow results

5

What to Look For in Search Results



Confirm the information relates to the same individual or entity



Check consistency with KYC information



Identify related individuals or entities



Look for relevant adverse information



Assess whether information is credible and from reliable sources

Common Identifiers Used in Searches



Name
(legal name, aliases)



Date of birth



City / state



ID number
(e.g., SSN, passport, driver's license)



Phone number



Email address



Employer or business name



Related entities or family members

Building Effective Search Strings

Employment & Business Relationship Searches



1

Purpose of These Searches



Verify stated occupation, employer or business activity



Confirm business relationships and professional roles



Useful for onboarding, KYC/CDD, EDD and investigations



Identify potential inconsistencies or undisclosed relationships

2

Key Search Elements



Individual name



Employer or business name



Occupation or professional title



City / state or location



Related companies or affiliates



Owners, directors or key management

3

Search from Multiple Perspectives



Customer → Employer

- Use individual name
- Add employer or business name



Employer → Customer

- Search the employer
- Look for key individuals (owners, directors, management)

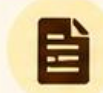


Explore Relationships

- Parent or subsidiary entities
- Business partners or affiliates

4

Information to Look For



Employment or business confirmation



Professional title or role



Ownership or director information



Related entities or affiliated companies



Industry or business activity alignment

5

Compare With KYC Information



Does the information support what the customer stated?



Is the customer reasonably connected to the employer or business?



Is the stated occupation consistent with available information?



Are there any unexplained differences in employer, title, location or activity?



Treat discrepancies as investigative points, not automatic proof of fraud

Common U.S. Sources



General Search Engines
(e.g., Google, Bing)



Secretary of State
Corporate Registries



SEC EDGAR
(SEC Filings)



FINRA
BrokerCheck



State Professional
Licensing Websites
(e.g., attorneys, accountants)



Company Websites
(self-reported information)

Building Effective Search Strings

Legal Entity & Formation Searches

BUSINESS REGISTRATION
ARTICLES OF ORGANIZATION
STATE CORPORATE RECORDS
ENTITY INFORMATION



1 Purpose of the Searches

-  Verify the legal existence of the entity
-  Understand the entity type, structure and formation details
-  Identify owners, directors and key management
-  Support KYC/CDD, EDD and investigations

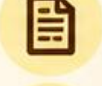
2 Key Search Terms

-  Legal entity name (full or partial)
-  Entity type (LLC, Corporation, Partnership, etc.)
-  State of formation or registration
-  Registration number (where available)
-  Owner, director or officer name
-  Related entities or affiliates

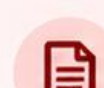
3 Build Targeted Search Strings

- **Entity Name Search**
 - Use exact legal entity name
 - Add state or registration number where needed
- **Owner / Director Search**
 - Use individual name
 - Combine with entity name
 - Include role-related terms (e.g., owner, director, CEO, member)
- **Include Additional Terms**
 - Add industry or business activity terms where relevant
 - Use quotations for exact names

4 Key Information to Review

-  Entity status (active, inactive, dissolved)
-  Formation and registration date
-  Registered agent (where available)
-  Business address
-  Entity type (LLC, Corporation, etc.)
-  Amendments, mergers or name changes (where available)

5 Common Sources for Legal Entity Searches

-  Secretary of State corporate registries (state websites)
-  SEC EDGAR (for SEC filers)
-  FINRA BrokerCheck (where relevant)
-  State and federal regulatory websites (where relevant)
-  Commercial research databases (as permitted)

Information Commonly Available from State Business Registries

-  Entity name and type
-  Registration number
-  Status (active/inactive)
-  Formation date
-  Registered agent
-  Business address
-  Filing history (where available)

Building Effective Search Strings

Business Address, Owner & Director Searches



1 Why These Searches Matter



Help verify the business address, existence and operations



Identify owners, directors and key management



Support KYC/CDD, EDD and investigations



Help assess whether the information is consistent and reasonable

2 Key Search Elements



Business address (city, state, full address)



Legal entity name (and variations)



Owners



Directors / officers



Key management



Related entities affiliates / parent company

3 Build Targeted Search Strings



Business Address

- Use full address or city/state
- Combine with business name
- Add relevant industry terms where needed



Owner / Director

- Use exact name
- Combine with business name
- Add role-related terms (e.g., owner, director, CEO)
- Include location where relevant



Search from Both Directions

- Customer/individual → Business
- Business → Owner/Director

4 Use Additional Identifiers



City / state



Business registration number (where available)



Employer or associated firm



Occupation or professional role



Parent, subsidiary or related companies



Any other relevant identifiers

5 Compare and Validate Results



Confirm the business appears to exist at the stated address



Verify owner/director information aligns with KYC information



Check for inconsistencies in name, address, ownership or management



Identify any relevant changes over time



Consider how the information supports the customer's business activity and expected account use

Common U.S. Sources



Secretary of State Corporate Registries



SEC EDGAR (SEC Filings)



FINRA BrokerCheck



State Licensing Websites



Business Websites (reliable sources)



Bank-Approved Research Tools

Building Effective Search Strings

Regulatory & Licensing Search Terms



1 Why These Searches Matter



Determine if a customer, business or professional is registered or licensed where relevant



Identify any regulatory actions or restrictions



Useful during KYC/CDD, EDD, periodic reviews and investigations



Focus on regulators relevant to the customer's business activity

2 Common Regulatory Search Terms



registration



license



disciplinary action



enforcement



suspension / revocation



complaint / consent order



cease and desist

3 Build Targeted Search Strings



Individuals

- Use exact name
- Add relevant regulatory or licensing terms
- Include location or state where needed



Businesses

- Use exact legal entity name
- Add regulator or licensing terms
- Include location or state where relevant



Consider Variations

- Use alternative job titles or industry terms
- Check both individual and business names

4 Use Identifiers Where Available



CRD number
(securities professionals)



SEC number
(where applicable)



NFA ID
(derivatives industry)



NMLS ID
(mortgage and certain financial services)



State professional license number
(e.g., attorney, accountant, doctor, contractor)

5 Review and Compare Results



Confirm registration/ license status



Review employer or associated firm



Compare location and professional role



Identify any disciplinary or regulatory actions



Distinguish between current, previous or terminated registration

Common U.S. Sources for Regulatory & Licensing Information



FINRA
BrokerCheck



SEC
Investment Adviser
Public Disclosure



NFA
BASIC



NMLS
Consumer Access



State Licensing Websites
(e.g., insurance, medical, legal, accounting)



Industry Regulators
(e.g., CFTC, FTC, State Attorneys General)

Building Effective Search Strings

Financial-Crime & Adverse Information Search Terms



1 Purpose of the Searches



Identify publicly available information relevant to financial-crime risk



Used during KYC/CDD, EDD, investigations and adverse-media reviews



Provide investigative leads, not proof of criminal activity



Results must be matched, evaluated and corroborated

2 Common Search Terms



Money laundering
structuring



Fraud
wire fraud
investment fraud



Corruption
bribery
kickback



Financial misconduct
insider trading
market manipulation



Enforcement
indictment, charged
civil complaint
settlement, conviction



Other relevant risks
sanctions evasion
tax fraud
identity theft

3 Build Targeted Search Strings



Individuals

- Use exact name
- Add relevant financial-crime terms
- Include location or employer where needed



Businesses

- Use exact legal entity name
- Add investigation-related terms
- Include location or industry where relevant



Use Quotation Marks

- Keep names together
- Helps find exact phrase
- Reduces irrelevant results

4 Add Identifiers to Reduce False Positives



City / state



Employer or business name



Occupation or professional role



Related entity



Additional identifiers as appropriate

5 Determine Relevance and Context



Understand the procedural status (allegation, investigation, charge, settlement, conviction)



Confirm the information relates to the same customer or entity



Consider the source and reliability



Evaluate how the information relates to the customer's risk profile and investigation objective

Common U.S. Sources



U.S. Department of Justice
Federal enforcement information



SEC
Litigation releases and enforcement information



FBI / U.S. Attorney
Federal investigations and prosecutions



State Regulators and Attorneys General
State-level enforcement information



Reputable News Sources
Reliable media coverage



Bank-Approved Research Tools
Broad adverse-media research

Building Effective Search Strings

Boolean Operators & Site-Specific Searches



SEC
DOJ
FINRA
STATE REGULATORS

1. Why They Matter



- Help **narrow**, **expand** or focus results when researching a customer, entity or individual
- **Improve** search **precision** and reduce irrelevant results
- Useful for KYC/CDD, EDD and investigations

2. AND – Narrow Results



- Use multiple relevant terms to narrow results
- Helps find pages that contain all key concepts
- Useful to connect the customer with specific identifiers

3. OR – Expand Results



- Use alternative terms to expand results
- Helpful for name variations or different ways to describe the same issue
- Increases the chance of finding relevant information

4. Minus (-) – Exclude Terms



- Use the minus operator to exclude irrelevant terms
- Helps reduce unrelated results (e.g., common names, unrelated topics)
- Use carefully to avoid removing relevant information

5. Quotation Marks – Exact Phrase



- Search for an exact word or phrase
- Improves search precision
- Useful for full names, legal entity names and specific allegations

6. site: – Specific Website



- Restrict results to a specific website or domain
- Useful for authoritative government or regulatory sources
- Helps quickly identify relevant information on official sites

Common U.S. Sources for Site-Specific Searches



SEC
(SEC.gov)



U.S. Department
of Justice
(Justice.gov)



FINRA
(BrokerCheck)



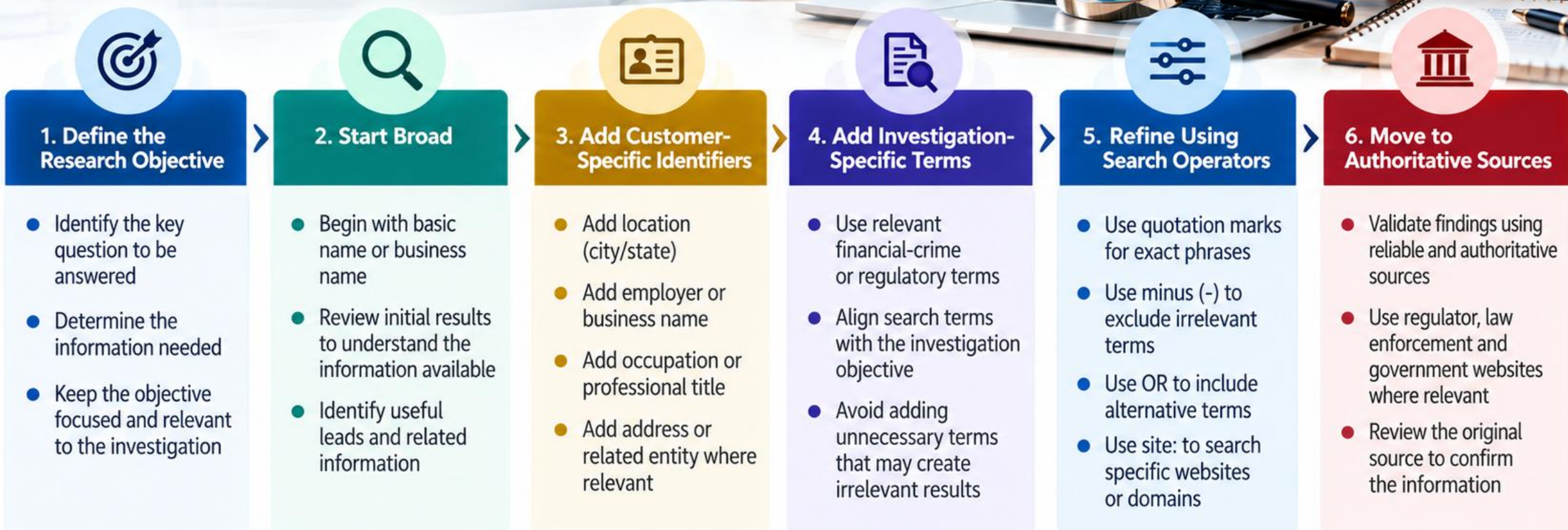
State Regulators
and Attorneys General
(state websites)



Other Authoritative
Government Websites
(as appropriate)

Building Effective Search Strings

Broad-to-Narrow Search Strategy & Result Refinement



BROAD SEARCH

NARROW & RELEVANT RESULTS

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Purpose & Principles of KYC Corroboration



1 Why Corroboration Is Important

-  Helps confirm the accuracy and reliability of customer information
-  Reduces the risk of identity fraud and misrepresentation
-  Supports a complete understanding of the customer's risk profile
-  Strengthens the quality of KYC/CDD and ongoing monitoring

2 What We Corroborate

-  Identity information (e.g., name, date of birth, address, identification number)
-  Business information (e.g., legal existence, registration details, industry, ownership)
-  Ownership and control information (e.g., beneficial owners, directors, key management)
-  Expected activity, occupation or business purpose where relevant

3 Sources Used for Corroboration

-  Reliable internal records (e.g., existing customer data, previous KYC)
-  Government and regulatory sources (e.g., state corporate registries, licensing agencies)
-  Reputable commercial databases and screening tools (e.g., sanctions, PEP, adverse media)
-  Open-source information from credible and reliable sources

4 Key Principles of Corroboration

-  Use multiple, independent and reliable sources where appropriate
-  Look for consistent information across sources
-  Consider the relevance, reliability and date of the information
-  Investigate and resolve material discrepancies
-  Apply a risk-based approach based on the customer's profile and risk rating

5 Outcome of Effective Corroboration

-  Greater confidence in the accuracy of customer information
-  Better informed risk assessment and decision making
-  Helps identify potential red flags or higher risk indicators
-  Supports more effective ongoing monitoring
-  Contributes to stronger compliance with BSA/AML requirements

Key Principles for Effective KYC Corroboration

-  Use multiple sources
-  Rely on independent and credible information
-  Assess relevance and reliability
-  Look for consistent information
-  Investigate discrepancies
-  Apply a risk-based approach

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Identity & Address Corroboration



1 Why Identity & Address Corroboration Matters

- Helps confirm the customer is who they claim to be
- Reduces the risk of identity fraud and synthetic identities
- Supports accurate risk assessment and monitoring
- Required as part of KYC/CIP and ongoing due diligence

2 Key Information to Corroborate

- Full legal name (including variations and aliases)
- Date of birth
- Residential address (current and past, where available)
- Identification number (e.g., SSN, passport, driver's license)
- Address type (residential, business, PO box, etc.)

3 Sources Used for Identity & Address Corroboration

- Government-issued documents** (e.g., driver's license, passport, state ID)
- Commercial databases** (e.g., credit bureau data, KYC data providers)
- Public records** (e.g., state DMV, voter registration, property records)
- Open-source information** (e.g., official websites, directories, maps)

4 Key Principles of Corroboration

- Use multiple, independent and reliable sources
- Look for consistent information across sources
- Assess the credibility and recency of the information
- Consider differences and explain any discrepancies
- Follow a risk-based approach based on the customer's profile

5 Outcome of Effective Identity & Address Corroboration

- Increases confidence in the customer's identity and address
- Supports accurate onboarding and risk rating
- Helps identify potential red flags or misrepresentation
- Provides a stronger foundation for ongoing monitoring
- Supports compliance with BSA/AML and regulatory requirements

Common Sources for Identity & Address Corroboration

- Government Databases (e.g., DMV, SSA)
- Credit Bureau Data
- Property Records and Tax Records
- Utility Bills and Service Providers
- Commercial KYC Databases
- Official Websites and Public Directories
- Mailing and Contact Verification Sources

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Employment & Professional Corroboration



1 Why Employment Corroboration Matters



Helps verify the customer's stated occupation and employer



Supports accurate risk assessment



Identifies potential misrepresentation in the customer profile



Useful for detecting potential fraud, money laundering or other financial crime risks

2 Key Information to Corroborate



Current and past employers



Job title and role



Industry and business sector



Employment dates and tenure



Company size and structure



Business location(s)

3 Sources Used for Employment Corroboration



Professional networking platforms (e.g., LinkedIn)



Company websites (e.g., About Us, leadership team, careers)



Business registries (e.g., Secretary of State records)



Reliable news and media articles



Industry publications and professional profiles

4 Key Principles of Corroboration



Use multiple, independent and reliable sources



Look for consistent information across sources



Consider the recency of the information



Be aware of differences in job titles or company naming



Investigate and resolve any discrepancies

5 Outcome of Effective Employment Corroboration



Greater confidence in the customer's professional information



Better informed risk assessment and monitoring



Helps identify potential red flags or inconsistencies



Supports ongoing monitoring and periodic reviews



Contributes to stronger compliance with BSA/AML and KYC requirements

Common Sources for Employment & Professional Corroboration



LinkedIn and professional networking sites



Company websites



Business registries



News and media articles



Industry publications and directories



Professional licenses and certifications



Court and regulatory records (where relevant)

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Business Existence & Nature-of-Business Corroboration



1

Why Business Existence Corroboration Matters



Confirms the business is real and legally exists



Helps detect potential shell companies or fronts



Reduces the risk of onboarding fictitious or high-risk entities



Supports accurate risk assessment and ongoing monitoring

2

Key Information to Corroborate



Legal entity name and formation details



Registration status (active, inactive, dissolved)



Business address and registered agent



Nature of business and industry



Ownership and management information (e.g., directors, members)

3

Sources Used for Business Corroboration



Government registries (e.g., Secretary of State)



Commercial databases (e.g., Dun & Bradstreet, LexisNexis)



Company website and official communications



Industry publications and business directories



News and media sources

4

Key Principles of Corroboration



Use multiple, independent and reliable sources



Look for consistent information across sources



Assess the recency and credibility of the information



Understand the business model and industry context



Investigate and resolve any discrepancies

5

Outcome of Effective Business Corroboration



Increases confidence that the business is legitimate



Better understanding of the nature of the business activities



Helps identify potential red flags (e.g., unusual business model, high-risk industry)



Supports ongoing monitoring and transaction analysis



Contributes to stronger compliance with BSA/AML and KYC requirements

Common Sources for Business Existence & Nature-of-Business Corroboration



Secretary of State business registries



Commercial databases



Company website



Industry directories



News and media sources



Professional and industry associations



Licenses and permits (where relevant)



Regulatory websites

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Ownership & Control–Person Corroboration



1 Why Ownership Corroboration Matters



Helps identify the real owners and control persons



Reduces the risk of concealment through complex structures



Supports accurate risk assessment and customer due diligence



Helps detect potential shell companies, front entities or opaque ownership structures

2 Key Information to Corroborate



Beneficial owner names and ownership percentage



Directors and key management personnel



Ownership structure (parent, subsidiary, ultimate owner)



Registration details and incorporation history



Control persons and individuals with significant influence

3 Sources Used for Ownership Corroboration



Government registries (e.g., Secretary of State, company registry)



Articles of incorporation and formation documents



Commercial databases (e.g., Dun & Bradstreet, LexisNexis)



Open-source information (e.g., company websites, news articles)



Industry publications and professional profiles

4 Key Principles of Corroboration



Use multiple, independent and reliable sources



Look for consistent information across sources



Understand direct and indirect ownership layers



Consider control through ownership, management or other means



Investigate and resolve any discrepancies

5 Outcome of Effective Ownership Corroboration



Greater confidence in the true ownership and control structure



Better ability to identify higher-risk owners or control persons



Helps meet regulatory requirements (e.g., CDD, beneficial ownership)



Supports ongoing monitoring and transaction analysis



Contributes to stronger compliance with BSA/AML and KYC requirements

Common Sources for Ownership & Control-Person Corroboration



Secretary of State business registries



Articles of incorporation



Commercial databases



Company websites



News and media sources



Professional networking sites



Industry publications



Regulatory websites

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Source of Funds & Source of Wealth Corroboration



1 Why Source of Funds & Source of Wealth Corroboration Matters	2 Key Information to Corroborate	3 Sources Used for Corroboration	4 Key Principles of Corroboration	5 Outcome of Effective Corroboration
- Helps confirm that account activity is consistent with the customer's stated financial profile - Reduces the risk of money laundering and illicit fund sources - Supports accurate risk assessment and ongoing monitoring - Provides a clearer understanding of the customer's broader financial background	- Source of funds (expected origin of money entering the account) - Source of wealth (overall wealth accumulation) - Employment or business income - Investments, real estate or asset sales - Inheritance, gifts or other non-employment sources	- Bank statements and account history - Tax returns (e.g., Form 1040, business tax filings) - Employment verification (e.g., pay slips, employer letters) - Property records (e.g., deeds, title records) - Investment statements (e.g., brokerage, retirement accounts) - Business financial records (e.g., financial statements, contracts)	- Use multiple, independent and reliable sources - Look for consistency across sources - Assess the reasonableness of the stated source of funds/wealth - Consider the customer's profile, occupation, industry and location - Investigate and resolve any discrepancies - Apply a risk-based approach based on the customer's overall profile	- Greater confidence that funds and wealth are from legitimate sources - Better ability to identify higher-risk customers and activities - Helps detect potential red flags (e.g., unexplained wealth, complex fund flows) - Supports ongoing monitoring and transaction analysis - Contributes to stronger compliance with BSA/AML and KYC requirements

Common Sources for Source of Funds & Source of Wealth Corroboration

Bank statements	Tax returns	Employment verification	Property records	Investment statements	Business financial records	Contracts and agreements	Inheritance and gift documents
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Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Geographic & Expected-Activity Corroboration



1

Why Geographic & Expected-Activity Corroboration Matters



Helps confirm the customer's stated locations and activities



Reduces the risk of undisclosed high-risk jurisdictions or activities



Supports accurate risk assessment and ongoing monitoring



Helps identify unusual or inconsistent geographic or transaction patterns

2

Key Information to Corroborate



Residential and business addresses



Business locations and operating regions



Travel patterns and international exposure



Customers, suppliers and counterparties' locations



Expected account activity by geography (e.g., domestic vs. international)

3

Sources Used for Geographic & Activity Corroboration



Government databases (e.g., address verification, corporate registries)



Open-source information (e.g., maps, company websites, news articles)



Travel and immigration records (where available)



Commercial databases (e.g., trade data, shipping records)



Counterparty and supplier information

4

Key Principles of Corroboration



Use multiple, independent and reliable sources



Look for consistency across sources



Consider the customer's industry, business model and geographic footprint



Assess whether activity aligns with the stated profile and expected use of the account



Investigate and resolve any discrepancies

5

Outcome of Effective Geographic & Activity Corroboration



Greater confidence in the customer's stated locations and activities



Better ability to identify higher-risk jurisdictions or unusual activity



Helps detect potential red flags (e.g., activity in high-risk countries, mismatches with expected activity)



Supports ongoing monitoring and transaction analysis



Contributes to stronger compliance with BSA/AML and KYC requirements

Common Sources for Geographic & Expected-Activity Corroboration



Government databases



Maps and geographic tools



Company websites



News and media articles



Travel and immigration records



Trade and shipping data



Counterparty information



Industry reports and market information

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Adverse Media & Customer-Match Corroboration



1

Why Adverse Media Corroboration Matters



Helps identify potential reputational, legal or financial risks



Supports a more complete understanding of the customer



Reduces the risk of engaging with higher-risk customers



Supports ongoing monitoring and timely escalation of relevant information

2

Key Information to Corroborate



Customer name and associated entities



Directors, beneficial owners and key individuals



Business activities, industry and sector



Locations and jurisdictions



Relevant dates (e.g., investigations, regulatory actions, legal proceedings)

3

Sources Used for Adverse Media Corroboration



Reputable news media (e.g., international and local news outlets)



Regulatory and enforcement websites (e.g., FinCEN, SEC, DOJ)



Court records and legal databases



Sanctions and watchlist related media coverage



Industry publications and specialist risk information providers

4

Key Principles of Corroboration



Use multiple, independent and reliable sources



Assess credibility, relevance and recency of the information



Understand the context and verify the connection to the customer



Consider potential name similarities or unrelated entities



Investigate and resolve any discrepancies

5

Outcome of Effective Adverse Media Corroboration



Greater confidence in the risk assessment



Better ability to identify potential red flags



Helps determine whether adverse information is relevant to the customer



Supports ongoing monitoring and escalation when needed



Contributes to stronger compliance with BSA/AML and KYC requirements

Common Sources for Adverse Media & Customer-Match Corroboration



Reputable news media



Regulatory websites (e.g., FinCEN, SEC, DOJ)



Court records and legal databases



Sanctions-related media sources



Industry publications and specialist providers



Company filings (e.g., SEC, annual reports)



Global media aggregators

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Source Independence, Reliability & Conflicting Information



1 Why Source Independence and Reliability Matter



Reduces the risk of relying on a single or biased source



Helps ensure information is accurate, credible and reliable



Supports a more balanced and objective risk assessment



Helps identify misinformation or incomplete information

2 Key Information to Corroborate



Information from at least two independent sources where appropriate



Customer identity, address, ownership and control



Business activities, industry and operations



Financial profile and expected activity



Adverse media, regulatory actions or negative information

3 Sources Used for Corroboration



Government and regulatory databases (e.g., Secretary of State, FinCEN, SEC, OFAC)



Commercial databases (e.g., Dun & Bradstreet, LexisNexis)



Reputable news media and industry publications



Company websites and official communications



Professional and industry sources (e.g., LinkedIn, trade associations)

4 Key Principles of Corroboration



Use independent and reliable sources



Assess the credibility and relevance of the source



Evaluate consistency of information across multiple sources



Consider the purpose, ownership and potential bias of the source



Investigate and resolve any conflicting information

5 Handling Conflicting Information



Identify the nature and significance of the discrepancy



Check for possible reasons (e.g., outdated information, different reporting sources)



Obtain additional independent sources to clarify the information



Escalate material conflicts according to bank procedures



Document the findings and rationale for the conclusion

Common Independent Sources for Corroboration



Government registries



Commercial databases



News media



Company websites



Professional profiles



Industry publications



Regulatory filings



Open-source information

Corroborating Findings Across Multiple Sources

Determining Sufficiency of Evidence



1

Why Sufficiency Assessment Matters



Helps confirm that customer information is adequately verified



Supports accurate risk assessment and appropriate due diligence



Reduces the risk of onboarding or retaining higher-risk customers with incomplete information



Provides a clear basis for decision-making and audit trail

2

Key Information to Assess



Completeness of information across key data elements



Consistency across multiple sources



Relevance and credibility of sources



Resolution of discrepancies or conflicting information



Alignment with the customer's risk profile and expected activity

3

Sources Used for Sufficiency Assessment



Government and regulatory databases (e.g., Secretary of State, FinCEN, SEC, OFAC)



Commercial databases (e.g., Dun & Bradstreet, LexisNexis)



Reputable news media and industry publications



Company websites and official communications



Counterparty, supplier and independent sources (where appropriate)

4

Key Principles of Sufficiency



Use multiple, independent and reliable sources



Assess completeness and consistency of information



Consider the customer's risk profile, complexity and expected activity



Evaluate and resolve material discrepancies



Ensure the evidence is reasonable and supports the overall KYC decision

5

Outcome of Effective Sufficiency Assessment



Greater confidence in the accuracy and reliability of customer information



Better identification of higher-risk customers and potential red flags



Clear documentation of evidence reviewed and how decisions were reached



Supports ongoing monitoring and future reviews



Stronger compliance with BSA/AML and KYC requirements

Common Sources for Assessing Sufficiency of Evidence



Government registries



Commercial databases



News media



Company websites



Counterparty information



Industry publications



Regulatory filings



Open-source information

Documenting Evidence & Findings

Documenting Evidence & Findings

Importance & Principles of KYC Documentation



Importance of KYC Documentation



Provides a **clear** and **auditable record** of the customer identification and verification process



Demonstrates **compliance with regulatory requirements** and internal policies



Supports **effective monitoring, investigations** and **decision-making**



Helps ensure **transparency, consistency and accountability** across the organization



Key Principles of KYC Documentation



Be **accurate, complete and up to date**



Maintain **sufficient detail** to support the due diligence performed



Organize and store documentation in a **clear, consistent and accessible** manner



Ensure documentation is **reliable, verifiable and retained** in line with regulatory and internal record-keeping requirements



Documenting Evidence & Findings

Customer Identification & Verification Documentation



What to Document



Customer's **legal name, date of birth** and **identification number**



Residential or business address and method of verification



Type of identification document reviewed and key details captured



Verification method used (documentary and/or non-documentary)



Source of the information and date it was obtained



Key Principles



Ensure documentation is **accurate, complete and up to date**



Record **how the customer was identified and verified**



Retain **clear copies or details** of identification documents as per policy



Document any **challenges, discrepancies or additional verification steps** taken



Maintain a **clear audit trail** that supports the bank's KYC and regulatory requirements

KYC Documentation

	Identity Documents	✓
	Address Verification	✓
	Document Review Notes	✓
	Verification Results	✓
	Audit Trail	✓

IDENTITY DOCUMENTS

ADDRESS PROOF

VERIFICATION RECORDS

DUE DILIGENCE NOTES

KYC AUDIT TRAIL



CUSTOMER IDENTIFICATION

Documenting Evidence & Findings

Nature, Purpose & Expected Activity Documentation



What to Document



Customer's stated **purpose for the account**



Nature of the business or customer activity



Expected account activity and transaction patterns



Related individuals, entities and their role



Source of funds/wealth details, where required



Key Principles



Ensure information is **accurate, clear and consistent** with other KYC data



Understand the **rationale for account activity** and customer's business needs



Assess whether the expected activity is **reasonable** for the **customer's profile**, industry and risk level



Update documentation when there are **significant changes** in customer activity



Maintain a **clear audit trail** of how the nature, purpose and expected activity were assessed



Documenting Evidence & Findings

Beneficial Ownership & Control Documentation



What to Document



Identified **beneficial owners** (individuals)



Ownership percentages and ownership structure



Control persons and their roles



Supporting documentation obtained and reviewed



Any **discrepancies, challenges** or **unresolved** information



Key Principles



Ensure documentation is **accurate, complete and supportable**



Verify information using **reliable and independent sources**



Retain copies of all **relevant documents and evidence**



Document **how ownership and control were determined** and any assumptions made



Keep documentation **up to date** and update when changes occur



Documenting Evidence & Findings

Source of Funds & Source of Wealth Documentation



What to Document



Customer's stated **source of funds** for account activity



Customer's stated **source of wealth** (broader wealth accumulation)



Supporting documents obtained and reviewed



Link to expected account activity and customer profile



Any **discrepancies, clarifications** or **additional information** obtained



Key Principles



Ensure documentation is **clear, complete and consistent**



Obtain information from **reliable and independent sources**



Assess whether the source of funds/wealth is **reasonable** given the customer's profile



Document **analysis**, any **assumptions** and follow-up actions taken



Keep all evidence **retained and up to date** in line with policy requirements



Documenting Evidence & Findings

Screening & External Research Documentation



What to Document



Screening results

(sanctions, PEP, adverse media)



External research sources

used and date of search



Key information

identified from external sources



Relevance to the customer

and risk assessment



Follow-up actions

taken based on the information



Key Principles



Ensure documentation is **accurate, complete and up to date**



Cite **reliable and independent sources** (e.g. official sources, reputable media, public records)



Record what was reviewed, **key findings** and how it relates to the customer



Document analyst's **assessment and conclusions** based on the results



Retain evidence of the research and any follow-up or escalation actions in accordance with policy



Documenting Evidence & Findings

Discrepancy Resolution & EDD Documentation



What to Document



Identified discrepancy
and details of the issue



Investigations and checks performed
to understand the discrepancy



Information obtained
from the customer and third parties



Additional due diligence (EDD)
steps taken



Final resolution and analyst conclusion
with supporting evidence



Key Principles



Thoroughly investigate
and understand the cause
of the discrepancy



Use **reliable and independent**
sources to validate information



Apply **appropriate EDD** based
on the risk and nature of the
discrepancy



Document the analysis,
customer explanations and
all follow-up steps



Ensure the **final decision,**
rationale and supporting
evidence are clearly recorded
and retained



Documenting Evidence & Findings

Risk Factors, Mitigants & Analyst Assessment



What to Document



Identified risk factors
relevant to the customer



Risk mitigants
and how they were considered



Analysis and rationale
for the risk rating



Supporting evidence
used in the assessment



Final analyst assessment
and conclusion



Key Principles



Ensure assessment is
fact-based, balanced
and **well-documented**



Consider both **risk factors**
and **mitigants** in the analysis



Link assessment to **reliable**
information and evidence
from multiple sources



Clearly explain the **rationale**
for the **assigned risk rating**
and any conditions or monitoring



Keep documentation
clear, complete and up to date
in line with policy requirements



Documenting Evidence & Findings

Escalation, Referral & Approval Documentation



What to Document



Reason for escalation
and key concerns



Who the case was escalated to
and when



Information shared
with the next level of review



Analyst's summary
of findings and recommendation



Final decision and approval
including rationale and any
conditions



Key Principles



Ensure documentation is
**accurate, complete and
timely**



Clearly explain why the case
was **escalated** or referred



Include all **relevant evidence,
analysis and supporting
documents**



Record **approvals, decisions**
and any required conditions
or next steps



Maintain a **clear audit trail**
from escalation to final
outcome

Escalation & Approval Process



Analyst
Identifies
Issue



Escalation /
Referral



Enhanced
Review



Decision &
Approval

Documentation Should Include

- ✓ Reason for escalation
- ✓ Key findings and evidence
- ✓ Details of reviewers / approvers
- ✓ Final decision and rationale
- ✓ Any conditions or next steps

ESCALATION RECORDS

CASE REFERRALS

MANAGEMENT REVIEW

APPROVAL DOCUMENTS

ANALYST NOTES

DECISION & RATIONALE

CASE ESCALATION REVIEW

Documenting Evidence & Findings

Final KYC/Onboarding Rationale



What to Document



Summary of customer information and key findings



Key risk factors and mitigants



Source of funds and source of wealth conclusion



Purpose of the relationship and **expected activity** assessment



Overall risk rating and recommended account decision



Key Principles



Ensure the rationale is **clear, concise and well-supported**



Link the decision to **customer information, risk assessment and evidence**



Demonstrate how any **risk factors were mitigated**



Reference **key sources of information** and analysis performed



Document the **final decision** and any conditions, monitoring or follow-up actions

